

Keepsake — Build Work Log

Per-phase summary of work, decisions, and changes

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Overview

This is a breadth-first **2.5D working prototype** of Keepsake, built across the Design Bible v3 phases (A–F). The goal is a coherent, testable experience that touches as many systems as possible rather than finishing any one to production depth. Everything runs in the browser (React 19 + TypeScript + Vite, Tailwind v4), persisted to **IndexedDB**; there is no backend yet, so account, storage, and multi-user systems are simulated *locally* and labelled as such.

Art direction. The room and chrome draw on *Little Big Planet* (handcrafted, tactile "pop-out" objects), *Sly Cooper* (storybook, bold stylised shapes, warm noir), and *What Remains of Edith Finch* (a cozy, slightly melancholic diorama house, warm light, drifting dust). It is realised in 2.5D with layered parallax, painterly gradients, grain, and soft vignette — the "2.5D over full 3D" open decision from Bible §4/§8.

Ideas that *deviate* from the Bible are collected in the companion "Suggestions & Deviations" PDF; quick, obvious fixes and any clear privacy/security issues are acted on directly and noted here.

Architecture at a glance

- `store/appStore` — one app state (profile, books, archive, environment, social, pins, timeline, achievements) with debounced IndexedDB autosave.
- `store/nav` — a small room-view router plus the local *View as* mode.
- `hooks/useScrapbook` — editor state over the active book.
- The room is the interface: a diorama hub whose objects open each system (Bible §2/§8).

PHASE A

Core scrapbook

Built

- Book → open two-page spread on a wooden desk; cream paper, spine shadow, drop shadows.
- Photographs as tactile prints (polaroid / tape / flush frames); select, drag, rotate, resize, restack, replace, remove.
- Positions stored as page percentages so layout holds across screen sizes (Bible requirement).

Notes

- Data model follows the Bible's `Scrapbook → Page → PageElement` shapes.

PHASE B Scrapbook MVP

Built

- Multi-photo pages (up to 6), z-order, sensible initial positions.
- Editable handwritten captions (character-limited) with sharpie ink colours.
- **Layout presets** — Grid / Column / Scatter for fast placement (§5).
- **Directional 3D page-turn** animation across the spine, with a reduced-motion instant-swap fallback (§7).
- **Stickers** as page elements sharing the photo/caption transform model (§11).

Changes / fixes

- Fixed two React StrictMode-exposed impurities discovered by testing (a preset counter and a page-turn commit that ran inside a state updater).

PHASE C Persistent product local

Built

- **Multiple books + bookshelf:** create, rename, choose leather cover, set visibility, delete; select a book by its cover (§9).
- **Filing cabinet / archive:** every uploaded photo is kept, searchable by category, favouritable; "place in book" adds a *reference* to the existing photo rather than duplicating it (§10).
- Per-book **visibility** (private / friends / public).

Simulated locally. Accounts, object storage, and server-side permission enforcement do not exist yet. Visibility is a local *preview* only (see Phase E and the "real vs simulated" section). Uploaded images are downscaled and stored as data URLs in IndexedDB.

PHASE D

Room alpha (2.5D)

Built

- A diorama **room hub** with three parallax depth layers that respond to the pointer; interactive objects lift and reveal a handwritten label on hover.
- Authored "camera views" (room → book / shelf / archive / timeline / map / guest book) via a simple view router — a CameraDirector stand-in (§8).
- **Window / day-night / seasons / weather / lamp**: sky and light shift with time (auto by clock, or forced), a seasonal tint, rain/snow, and a warm lamp glow after dark (§14).
- Ambient **dust motes** and grain for the Edith-Finch mood.

Fixes

- Parallax layer wrappers were intercepting clicks; made them non-interactive so objects beneath remain clickable.

PHASE E

Social

local sim

Built

- **Visitor "View as"** (Close friend / Friend / Public) previews the room and library through a visitor's eyes; private books and the archive are hidden accordingly, and the book editor becomes read-only (§17/§18).
- **Guest book** — flat, non-threaded notes, no counters or reply chains (§19).
- **Page notes + approval + whispers** — a visitor can leave a short note on a spread; it stays hidden until the owner approves it; approved notes then occasionally drift into the room as a quiet, dismissible "whisper" (§19).

Simulated locally. There are no real other users; "View as" is a client-side preview and notes/visibility are enforced only in the UI. A real permission-inheritance engine and server enforcement are required before any actual sharing (§17).

PHASE F

Expansion

Built

- **Timeline wall** — add year milestones on a vertical line (§15).
- **Memory atlas / map** — an illustrated map; click to pin a place + note; exact coordinates are never used (approximate/manual by default, §16).
- **Craft drawer / stickers** in the editor (§11).

- **Hidden achievements** — discovered as gentle "keepsakes found" with a quiet toast; a panel lists found vs undiscovered (§12/§21).
- **CRT music** — a generative ambient pad via the Web Audio API, toggled by the CRT, volume from room settings; offline-safe and licence-free (§13).
- **Curated RNG** — a session-limited "letter on the desk" that waits quietly to be opened, never interrupting (§20).
- **Export / print** — a print-ready view of a book; "Save as PDF" in the browser produces a shareable keepsake (§25, software half).
- **Offline read mode** — a service worker + web manifest cache the app shell and assets (production build), and scrapbook data already lives in IndexedDB, so a loaded room can be revisited offline and installed to the home screen (§22).

Deviations acted on during the build

Change	Why	Bible
Persist photos (as data URLs) so books survive a refresh	Much better to actually test with; small change	§3 (prototype images were "intentionally temporary")
Client-side visibility gating for private books / archive and "View as"	A clear privacy expectation; implemented as an honest local preview and flagged that real enforcement is server-side	§17
Downscale uploads to ≤1400px	Protects browser memory / storage quota	§6/§22 (listed risks)

Anything larger or subjective was *not* acted on — it lives in the Suggestions & Deviations PDF for your review.

Real vs simulated (please read)

- **Real & local:** the whole editor, room, environment, library, archive, timeline, map, guest book, achievements, music, export — all working in the browser and saved to IndexedDB.
- **Simulated (no backend yet):** accounts, cloud photo storage, multi-user visiting, and *server-side privacy enforcement*. "View as" and visibility are previews, not security. This is the top risk area in the Bible (§17) and needs a real backend before any sharing is enabled.

Testing

- `npm run build` (tsc + vite) passes with no type errors.
- Browser-verified end to end: room navigation to every object; open/edit book (photos, captions, stickers, presets, page turns, export); day → night in the window; bookshelf, archive (search/favourite/place-in-book), timeline, map (pin), guest book; "View as" gating.
- No red console errors. (A few ally hints about form labels remain — see suggestions.)

Where this could go next

- A real backend (Postgres + auth + object storage) and a proper permission-inheritance engine, turning the local "View as"/visibility previews into real, enforced privacy (§17).
- Undo/redo and richer mobile gestures in the editor.
- Replace CSS/SVG room with commissioned illustrated parallax layers (see suggestions).
- A fuller curated-RNG opportunity queue and an achievement event-ledger (§12/§20).